IS101 — Excel E2: Manage Data Cells & Ranges

College of Southern Nevada

Practice Instructions

Download and open your **Excel_E2_Starter** file. Work through each skill below using the steps provided — each skill lists what to do, exactly how to do it, and what the result should look like. Check off each skill on the IS101 reference page as you complete it.

Skills in This Guide

1 Paste Using Special Paste Options
2 Fill Cells by Using AutoFill
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4 Insert and Delete Cells
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1. Paste Using Special Paste Options

Your Task: Copy a column of formulas and paste only its calculated values elsewhere, without the formulas.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select and copy a range of formula cells (Ctrl+C).
2. Click the destination cell.
3. Click Home → Paste dropdown → Paste Special.
4. Choose Values and click OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The destination cells show the same numbers, but the formula bar shows plain values, not formulas.

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2. Fill Cells by Using AutoFill

Your Task: The month column shows only January — use AutoFill to complete the rest of the year down the column.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the cell containing “January.”
2. Hover over the small fill handle at its bottom-right corner.
3. Click and drag the fill handle down through the remaining blank cells.
4. Release the mouse button.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The previously blank cells now show February, March, April, and so on, continuing the pattern.

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3. Insert and Delete Multiple Columns or Rows

Your Task: Insert two new blank columns before an existing column, then delete one unneeded row.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select two adjacent column headers.
2. Right-click and choose Insert.
3. Select an unneeded row's header, right-click, and choose Delete.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

Two new blank columns appear where selected, and the chosen row is removed with rows below shifting up.

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4. Insert and Delete Cells

Your Task: Insert a single blank cell above a value, shifting the rest of the column down, then delete a cell.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Right-click the cell above which you want a new one.
2. Choose Insert → Shift Cells Down → OK.
3. Right-click a different cell you want removed.
4. Choose Delete → Shift Cells Up → OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

A new blank cell appears and pushes the column's remaining values down by one row; the deleted cell's column pulls values up by one.

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5. Generate Data with RANDBETWEEN() and SEQUENCE()

Your Task: Generate a column of random sample scores and a column of sequential ID numbers.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click a blank cell and type =RANDBETWEEN(60,100), then press Enter.
2. Click a different blank cell and type =SEQUENCE(10), then press Enter.
3. Fill or copy each formula down as needed.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

RANDBETWEEN returns a random whole number in the given range; SEQUENCE spills a column of increasing numbers automatically.

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6. Merge and Unmerge Cells

Your Task: Merge a row of cells into one title cell spanning the table, then unmerge it again.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the range of cells to combine into a title.
2. Click Home → Merge & Center.
3. To reverse it, select the merged cell and click Merge & Center again to unmerge.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The selected cells become one wide cell with the title centered; unmerging restores the original individual cells.

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7. Modify Alignment, Orientation, and Indentation

Your Task: Center a header row both horizontally and vertically, then angle a column label 45 degrees.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the header row and click the center alignment buttons in Home → Alignment.
2. Select a column label cell, click the Orientation button, and choose Angle Counterclockwise.
3. Select a data cell and click Increase Indent once.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The header text is centered in its cells, the chosen label appears tilted, and the indented cell's text shifts right slightly.

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8. Format Cells by Using Format Painter

Your Task: Copy the formatting from one nicely formatted cell onto a plain one without retyping any formatting.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the cell whose formatting you want to copy.
2. Click Home → Format Painter.
3. Click (or drag across) the target cell(s) to apply the copied formatting.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The target cells instantly match the source cell's font, fill, and border formatting, with their own data unchanged.

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9. Wrap Text Within Cells

Your Task: A long description is overflowing its cell into the neighbors — wrap it to fit within its own column.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the cell containing the long text.
2. Click Home → Wrap Text.
3. Adjust the row height if needed so all wrapped lines are visible.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The text now breaks onto multiple lines within its own cell instead of spilling into adjacent cells.

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10. Apply Number Formats

Your Task: Format a column of dollar amounts as currency and a column of fractions as percentages.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the dollar-amount column.
2. Click Home → Number format dropdown → Currency.
3. Select the fraction column.
4. Click the Percent Style button (or choose Percentage from the dropdown).

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The first column shows values with a dollar sign and two decimals; the second shows values as whole-number percentages.

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11. Apply Cell Formats (Font, Fill, Border)

Your Task: Give the header row bold white text on a colored fill, with a border around the whole table.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the header row, press Ctrl+1 to open Format Cells.
2. On the Font tab, set Bold and white Font Color, then click the Fill tab and pick a color.
3. Select the full table range, reopen Format Cells → Border tab, choose Outline and Inside, then OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The header row stands out with bold white text on a colored background, and the table has visible borders throughout.

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12. Apply Cell Styles (Named)

Your Task: Apply a built-in named style, like “Good” or “Heading 1,” instead of formatting cells manually.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the range to style.
2. Click Home → Cell Styles.
3. Choose a named style such as Heading 1 or Good from the gallery.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The selected cells instantly take on that named style's font, color, and fill, and the style name is now attached to them.

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13. Clear Cell Formatting

Your Task: Remove all formatting from a range while keeping its data and formulas intact.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the formatted range.
2. Click Home → Clear dropdown → Clear Formats.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The cells revert to plain default formatting (no fill, bold, or borders), but every value and formula stays exactly as it was.

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14. Format Multiple Worksheets by Grouping

Your Task: Apply the same header formatting to several worksheets at once by grouping their tabs.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the first sheet tab, then Shift-click the last sheet tab you want to include.
2. With the tabs grouped (shown in the title bar), format the header row on the active sheet.
3. Right-click any grouped tab and choose Ungroup Sheets when finished.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The formatting you applied appears identically on every grouped sheet, not just the one you were looking at.

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15. Define a Named Range

Your Task: Give a range of sales figures a memorable name so it's easy to reference later.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the range of cells to name.
2. Click the Name Box at the left of the formula bar.
3. Type Sales_Data (no spaces) and press Enter.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The Name Box shows Sales_Data whenever that range is selected, and the name is available anywhere in the workbook.

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16. Reference a Named Range

Your Task: Use the named range you just created inside a formula instead of typing its cell addresses.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click a blank cell.
2. Type =SUM(and then, instead of selecting cells, type Sales_Data.
3. Close the parenthesis and press Enter.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The formula bar shows =SUM(Sales_Data) and the cell returns the total of that named range.

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17. Insert Sparklines

Your Task: Add a small in-cell line chart next to each row showing that row's trend at a glance.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select a blank cell next to a row of numeric data.
2. Click Insert → Line (under Sparklines).
3. In the Data Range box, select the row of numbers, then click OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

A tiny line chart appears inside the single cell, tracing the row's values from left to right.

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18. Apply Built-in Conditional Formatting

Your Task: Highlight every value in a column that falls below a target threshold.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the column of values.
2. Click Home → Conditional Formatting → Highlight Cells Rules → Less Than.
3. Enter the threshold value, choose a formatting style, and click OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

Every cell below the threshold is automatically shaded with the chosen formatting; the rest are untouched.

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19. Remove Conditional Formatting

Your Task: Remove the conditional formatting rule you just applied, restoring the cells to normal.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the range with the conditional formatting.
2. Click Home → Conditional Formatting → Clear Rules → Clear Rules from Selected Cells.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE

The special shading disappears immediately and the cells return to their prior formatting, with values unchanged.

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